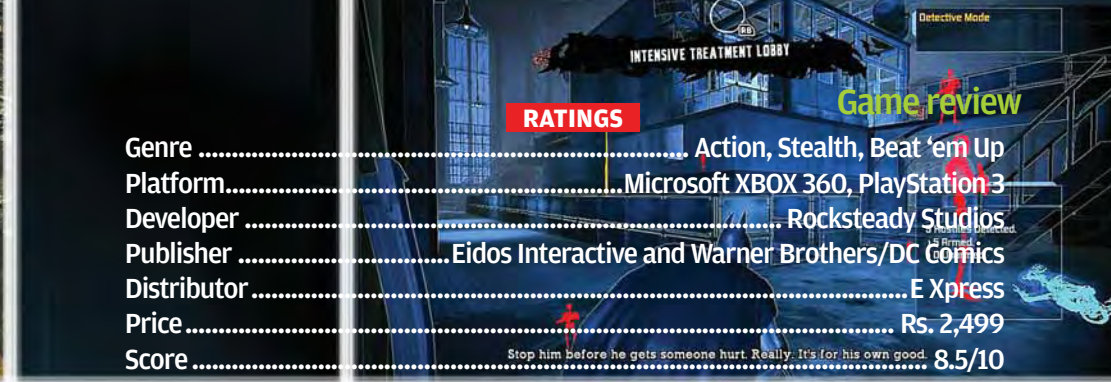




Genre	Action, Stealth, Beat 'em Up
Platform.....	Microsoft XBOX 360, PlayStation 3
Developer	Rocksteady Studios
Publisher	Eidos Interactive and Warner Brothers/DC Comics
Distributor	E Xpress
Price	Rs. 2,499
Score	8.5/10

isolated enemies firing at nothing, out of sheer nervousness.

Journey into Knight

The game uses to the famed Unreal 3 and PhysX engine along with other technologies like SpeedTree, IDV, ScaleForm, etc. to render the dark and gloomy landscape of Arkham Asylum, with a slick vector based heads up display (HUD). Along with the customary health display, the HUD is also used to access and switch between gadgets in Batman's utility belt. If you cannot find your way to the next objective or locate that last secret in a location, the game menu can be used to bring up a 2D schematic of Arkham.

Although the game characters might seem a little buffed up, they are modeled with an uncanny resemblance to some

night are clearly visible on him. The artists of the game have used certain artistic license to deliver the visual feedback. As the game progresses Batman sports a stubble, his cape has holes in it and there are cuts and bruises through his armor.

Riddle Factory

You are having so much fun playing this game that the Story Mode

All of these secrets are not accessible from the beginning of the game as they may require gadgets that become available at a later stage of the game. This means that if you want to achieve 100% game completion, you'll have to do some back tracking with a complete arsenal of Wayne Tech equipment.

As mentioned earlier, progressing through the game and locating these secrets will unlock a bit of Batman lore. In addition to this however, it will also unlock challenge mode stages. Just like in the game, there are two types of scenarios—stealth and combat. There are a total of four combat challenges and four stealth challenges available to be unlocked. Each of these stages also has an "Extreme" mode, effectively taking the total number of challenges to 16 stages. On completion of these challenges, your total score for that stage is calculated and uploaded on the online leader boards.

Worlds' Finest

It is not easy making a crossover game, especially ones based on a superhero and understandably solid games in this genre are few and far in between. The good news is that Arkham Asylum is easily one of the best ever made in this category. In

fact, even if you are not a big fan the Batman mythos you'll still enjoy this game. With the exception of gunplay, this game has something for every typical gamer. There are sections of the game that require stealth and patience and works well for those who look for a bit of strategy in a game. The combat system is robust and free flowing that at times warrants good reflexes with the gamepad, especially in the later part of the game and in Challenge Mode. And for those gamers that enjoy exploration, there are secrets to be found and rewards to be unlocked.

Arguably, the only things that go against this game is it's short length and somewhat disappointing boss battles. **d**

of the comic book art. The Joker constantly tries to breakdown Batman's psyche by mocking him using the facilities video feed and the PA system. And The Joker is only one of Batman's problems this night along with The Scarecrow, Poison Ivy, Killer Croc, Bane and Mr. Zsasz.

Due to Batman's training and conditioning it may not be easy to break his constitution, but the effects of this grueling

may seem a little short lasting between eight to ten hours. After you beat the single player mode, there are a couple of other things to keep you busy.

The Riddler also has a challenge for Batman this night and he has hidden away secrets throughout Arkham.

These are sometimes placed in plain sight while others are hidden away behind grates and breakable walls. These secrets come in various forms like the Riddler's Trophy, Patients Interview Tapes, The Chronicles of Arkham and some more. The game measures completion of your game by the progress you've made in the Story Mode along with the number of secrets you have discovered.

